



NATIONAL SECURITY AGENCY
CENTRAL SECURITY SERVICE
FORT GEORGE G. MEADE, MARYLAND 20755

Serial: N9094
10 JAN 1980

SP5 Clifford E. Stone
[REDACTED]
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Dear Specialist Stone:

This replies to your Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requests of July 16, 1978 and February 21, 1979 in which you request any information that this Agency may have concerning Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs).

Your request has been processed in accordance with 5 U.S.C. 552, the Freedom of Information Act. Two documents that are within the scope of your request are enclosed.

These documents were released pursuant to an administrative appeal under the FOIA. The documents were written in 1968 by an NSA employee with an interest in UFOs. One of the documents was originally classified because portions of it tangentially discussed protected activities pertaining to the NSA. Most of the remaining portions of the documents reflected open-source information on UFOs. We wish to emphasize that these draft documents were never published, formally issued, acted upon, or responded to by any government official or agency. Moreover, they are not "NSA reports" per se, and they in no way reflect an official NSA position concerning UFOs. They are subject to the provisions of the FOIA only because they have been retained by this Agency for historical reference purposes.

Deletions have been made to these two documents pursuant to the following provisions of Title 5 U.S.C. 552, the FOIA:

1. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(1), which provides that the FOIA does not apply to matters that are specifically authorized under criteria established by an Executive Order to be kept secret in the interest of national defense or foreign policy and are in fact properly classified pursuant to such Executive Order. The classified information that has been deleted from the enclosed records is currently and properly classified in accordance with the criteria for classification in Section 1-3 of Executive Order 12065, and paragraph 2-202 of Department of Defense (DoD) Regulation 5200.1-R. The information has been reviewed for possible declassification or downgrading according to the provisions of Sections 3-3, 3-4, and 3-6 of Executive Order 12065 and Chapter III of DoD Regulation 5200.1-R and found to be properly excluded from declassification or downgrading.

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2. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(3), which provides that the FOIA does not apply to matters that are specifically exempted from disclosure by statute. The applicable statutes in this case are Title 18 U.S.C. 798, Title 50 U.S.C. 403(d)(3), and Public Law 86-36.

Other records that fall within the scope of your request are being withheld in their entirety. These records are exempt from disclosure pursuant to the following provisions of the FOIA:

1. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(1);
2. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(3), in conjunction with Title 18 U.S.C. 798, Title 50 U.S.C. 403(d)(3), and Public Law 86-36;
3. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(5); which exempts inter-agency or intra-agency memorandums or letters which would not be available by law to a party other than an agency in litigation with this Agency;
4. Title 5 U.S.C. 552(b)(6), which provides that the FOIA does not apply to personnel and similar files the disclosure of which would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy.

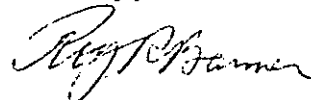
No portion of the information being withheld in its entirety is reasonably segregable.

Certain other information, which originated with other Federal agencies and components, is also being withheld. Department of Defense (DoD) Directive 5400.7, which implements the FOIA for all DoD agencies, provides that when records requested under the FOIA originate with another agency or component, the request shall be referred to that agency or component for disposition. The agencies to which we have referred records will correspond directly with you concerning those records.

Since your requests have been denied in part, you are hereby advised of this Agency's appeal procedures.

Any person denied access to records may, within 30 days after notification of such denial, file an appeal to the NSA/CSS Freedom of Information Act Appeal Authority, National Security Agency, Fort George G. Meade, MD 20755. The appeal shall reference the initial denial of access and shall contain, in sufficient detail and particularity, the grounds upon which the requester believes release of the information is required. The NSA/CSS Appeal Authority shall respond to the appeal within 20 working days after receipt.

Sincerely,



ROY R. BANNER
Chief, Policy Staff

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U F O HYPOTHESIS AND SURVIVAL QUESTIONS

It is the purpose of this monograph to consider briefly some of the human survival implications suggested by the various principal hypothesis concerning the nature of the phenomena loosely categorized as U F O (1).

1. ALL UFO'S ARE HOAXES: From the time when hoaxes were first noted in history, they were characterized by infrequency of occurrence and usually by a considerable restriction of their geographical extent. Rarely have men of science, while acting within their professional capacities, perpetrated hoaxes. The fact that UFO phenomenon have been witnessed all over the world from ancient times, and by considerable numbers of reputable scientists in recent times, indicates rather strongly that UFO's are not all hoaxes. (2) ^{RATHER THEY ARE DIMINISHING,} If anything, the modern trend is toward increased reports, from all sources. In one three month period in 1953 (June, July, and August) Air Force records show 35 sightings whose nature could not be determined (3). If UFO's, contrary to all

(1) All flying, sailing or maneuvering aerial objects whether glowing, pulsating, or of a constant metallic hue, whose shape is somewhat circular or cigarish.

(2) Anatomy of a Phenomenon, Jacques Vallee, Henry Regnery Co. Chicago, 1965. p 9-17. (Vallee has degrees in Astronomy and Physics and is currently consultant to NASA's MARS MAP STUDY.)

(3) United States Air Force Projects Grudge and Bluebook Reports 1-12 (1951-1953) National Investigation Committee on Aerial Phenomena. Washington June 1968. p 216.

(4) Visitors from Outer Space, Sputnik, (condensed from the almanac on Land and Sea) V. Leonidov Zeitsev, p 164-181.

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indications and expectations, are indeed hoaxes - hoaxes of a world-wide dimension - hoaxes of increasing frequency, then a human mental aberration of alarming proportions would appear to be developing. Such an aberration would seem to have serious implications for nations equipped with nuclear toys - and should require immediate and careful study by scientists.

2. ALL UFO's ARE HALLUCINATIONS: People, of course, do hallucinate. Although groups of people hallucinating is rare, it has been known to happen. Machines have their own form of hallucination; the radar, in particular, "sees" temperature inversions. But a considerable number of instances exist in which there are groups of people and a radar or radars seeing the same thing at the same time; sometimes a person and a gun-camera confirm each other's testimony⁽⁴⁾. On occasion, physical evidence of a circumstantial nature was reported to have been found to support witnessed sightings⁽⁵⁾. A continuing high percentage of reports of unusual aerial objects are being reported by people in responsible positions in science, government, and industry.⁽⁶⁾ The sum of such evidence seems to argue strongly against all UFO's being hallucinations.

{ In spite of all the evidence to the contrary, if UFO's did turn out to be largely illusory, the psychological implications for man would

on next page

(4) *ibid.*, p 208, 192, 149, 146

(5) *op. cit.*, Vallee, p. 70, 71, 74.

(6) *The Report on Unidentified Flying Objects*, Edward J. Ruppelt, Doubleday, New York 1956. p 242. (Ruppelt was Chief of the Bluebook Study at one time.)

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certainly bring into strong question his ability to distinguish reality from fantasy. The negative effect on man's ability to survive in an increasingly complex world would be considerable - making it imperative that such a growing impairment of the human capacity for rational judgment be subjected to immediate and thorough scientific study - so that the illness could be controlled before it reaches epidemic proportions (7).

(For comments on mass hysteria and UFO's see source 8 below which contains a statement by Dr. Robert L. Hall, a social psychologist formerly with the AF Personnel and Training Research Center and the Program Director, Sociology and Psychology, National Science Foundation.)

3. ALL UFO's ARE NATURAL PHENOMENA: If this hypothesis is correct the capability of air warning systems to correctly diagnose an attack situation is open to serious question.

(→ 2) a. Many UFO's have been reported by trained military observers to behave like high speed, high performance, high altitude rockets or aircraft. The apparent solidity and craft-like shape of the objects have often been subject to radar confirmation (9). If such objects can appear to trained military men as rockets or air craft and if such objects

(7) op. cit., Ruppelt p 237 (Dutch Liner, Rome, Italy)

(8) Symposium on Unidentified Flying Objects (Second Session).

July 29, 1958 nr 7 (House Committee on Science and Astronautics).

(9) op. cit., Project Grudge, pp. 192, 149, 146.

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should come over the Arctic from the direction of Russia on the United States, they could trigger "false reports of missile attacks". (10)

b. Many responsible military officers have developed a mental "blind spot" to objects which appear to have the characteristics of UFO's. (10) Such an attitude is an open invitation to the enemy to build a replica of the phenomena in order to penetrate the "hole" in his adversaries' defenses - Was this the purpose of the lens shaped reentry vehicle tested by the U.S. Air Force in 1960 and recently featured in the Washington, D.C. Evening Star, dated 24 September 1968, page A4?

c. Sometimes the phenomena appear to defy radar detection and to cause massive electromagnetic interference. Surely it is very important to discover the nature of these objects or plasmas before any prospective enemy can use their properties to build a device or system to circumvent or jam our air and space detection systems - Any nation certainly could use a system or device to penetrate enemy defenses. (11)

4. SOME UFO'S ARE SECRET EARTH PROJECTS: The above referenced U.S. Air Force reentry vehicle and an often publicized Canadian "saucer" project (9) leave little doubt as to the validity of this hypothesis.

(Undoubtedly, all UFO's should be carefully scrutinized to ferret out such enemy (or "friendly") projects. Otherwise a nation faces the very strong

(10) Flying Phenomena, Sovetskaya Latvya, No. 287, 19 December 1967, p 3, Col 1-3, by R. Vitchniyek (Director of the Station for the Radio Observation of the Ionosphere and Artificial Earth Satellites).

(11) ibid., Project Grudge.

UFO's and the Colorado Project, Encyclopedia Britannica Book of the Year

possibility of being intimidated by a new secret "doomsday" weapon.

5. SOME UFO's ARE BELIEVED TO INTERFERE WITH INTELLIGENCE: According to a 1951 report, "The study of this phenomenon, this hypothesis cannot be dismissed." 12 (The first documented sighting was in 1952, during the Vietnam War). This hypothesis has a number of far-reaching human survival implications:

a. If "they" discover you, it is an old but hardly invalid rule of thumb, "they" are your technological superiors. Human history has shown us time and again the tragic results of a confrontation between a technologically superior civilization and a technologically inferior people. The "inferior" is usually subject to physical conquest.

b. Often in the past, a technologically superior people are also possessors of a more virile or aggressive culture. In a confrontation between two peoples of significantly different cultural levels, those having the inferior or less virile culture, most often suffer a tragic loss of identity and are usually absorbed by the other people.

c. Some peoples who were technologically and/or culturally inferior to other nations have survived - have maintained their identity - have equalized the differences between them and their adversaries. The Japanese people have given us an excellent example of the methods required to achieve such a survival:

(1) full and honest acceptance of the nature of the inferiorities separating you from the advantages of the other peoples,

(2) complete national solidarity in all positions taken in dealing with the other culture,

(3) highly controlled and limited intercourse with the other side - doing only those actions advantageous to the foreigner which you are absolutely forced to do by circumstances,

(4) a correct but friendly attitude toward the other people,

12. Professor JAMES E. MACDONALD, Astronomer, Professor ALLEN J. VYNNEK, Astrophysicist, JACQUES VALLEE, Astronomer, Science Press, Astronomer, University of the Pacific, objects are probably EXTRA-TERRRESTRIAL in origin is also supported by a 1953 report by Brazilian astronomer SAUL LOEB, "Scientific Investigations."

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(5) A national eagerness to learn everything possible about the other culture - its technological and cultural strengths and weaknesses. This often involves sending selected groups and individuals to the other's country to become one of his kind, or even to help him in his wars against other adversaries.

(6) Adopting as many of the advantages of the opposing people as you can, and doing it as fast as possible - while still protecting your own identity by molding each new knowledge increment into your own cultural cast.

6. COMMENT: Although this paper has hardly exhausted the possible hypotheses related to the UFO phenomena, those mentioned above are the principal ones presently put forward. All of them have serious survival implications. The final answer to this mystery will probably include more than one of the above hypotheses.

Up until this time, the leisurely scientific approach has too often taken precedence in dealing with UFO questions. If you are walking along a forest path and someone yells, "rattler" your reaction would be immediate and defensive. You would not take time to speculate before you act. You would have to treat the alarm as if it were a real and immediate threat to your survival. Investigation would become an intensive emergency action to isolate the threat and to determine its precise nature - It would be geared to developing adequate defensive measures in a minimum amount of time.

It would seem a little more of this survival attitude is called for in dealing with the UFO problem.

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Observations of chimpanzees while in a captive environment have shown that the animals tend to become confused and disoriented. Since they do not usually have adult chimps to teach them how to be good apes, they are not even sure of their behavior. Often their actions are patterned after human behavior and would have virtually no survival value in the wild. Lacking the challenge of environmental adaptation, the bodies of the animals atrophy and become subject to many diseases - mostly unknown in their wild counterparts. Reactions to stimuli usually become less responsive and suitable. Sex often becomes a year-long preoccupation instead of a seasonal madness.

Do the captivity characteristics of modern civilization cause a similar lessening of man's adaptive capability, of his health, of his ability to recognize reality, of his ability to survive?

Perhaps the UFO question might even make man undertake studies which could enable him to construct a society which is most conducive to developing a completely human being, healthy in all aspects of mind and body - and most important able to recognize and adapt to real environmental situations.

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SUBJECT: UFO's |

2. Scientific Findings: Dr. Jacques Vallee* famed communications science expert has studied thousands of cases where human beings have observed unusual phenomena. He has found that the human response to such observation is predictable and graphically depictable. Whether the person's psychological structure is being assaulted by the unusual and shocking brutality of a murder or the strangeness of a UFO sighting, the effect is the same:

a. Initially as by a kind of psychological interia, the mind records fairly objectively what the eye is reporting.*

b. But when it has realized the strange nature of the phenomena it goes into shock. The mind likes to live in a comfortable world where it feels it knows what to expect, and that, is not too threatening either physically or psychologically. The unusual dispells the comfortable illusion the mind has created. This shock tears at the very mooring of the human psychological structure.*

c. To protect itself against such an intrusive and threatening reality the mind will begin to add imagination and interpretation to the incoming data to make it more acceptable. Since the mind is doing all this in haste some of the hurriedly added details and suggestions tumble over one another and contradict one another in a bizzare fashion (as any police officer interrogating murder witnesses will tell you*) (See Chart A).

d. Once the mind has constructed a "safe" framework for the new information it may again peek out and collect some more objective data. If the data is still threatening it will again go into shock and the process starts all over again.*

e. If the data is at the highest strangness level where it brings terror either:

(1) The mind will pass out and go into amnesia burying the events perhaps permanently in the unconscious.*

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(2) The personal psychological structure will collapse and the mind will reach down into its deepest place where "that which cannot be destroyed" is and it will abandon itself to this entity for survival protection. Encounter with this changeless indestructible entity is usually referred to as a religious experience. In the confusion and the shock, this experience is often attributed to the shocking event or object and that is why primitive peoples worship such bizzare things as airplanes or cigarette lighters.

f. The degree of strangeness of the phenomena dictates how many people the mind is willing and able to tell the event to. A mildly unusual or shocking event will be told to many people. A very shocking event of high strangeness will be told to few people or practically none at all. Occasionally the event is so shockingly unusual that it isn't even reported to the person's conscious mind but is buried in the unconscious of the person* where it is only accessible to hypnosis or careful level six communication sharing with another person. (See Chart B.)

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Appendix

Other Examples of Blindness to Surprise Material Causing Defeat

1. Because the Aztecs could not conceive of the Spanish as human enemies, they were destroyed by this sudden invasion of alien Gods who could not be defended against.
2. Because the Spanish could not believe that those crude Americans could build a modern effective naval force their outmoded ships were swiftly destroyed at Cuba and the Philippines in the Spanish-American War.
3. Because the French had such absolute faith in their maginot line they refused to believe that the radically new small swift blitzkrieg army could outflank their line and shock them into a disorganized route in 1940.
4. Because we could not appreciate the power of the novel carrier strike force were surprised and defeated at Pearl Harbor.
5. Because Yamamoto was not aware that the most important ship in the modern fleet was the novel aircraft carrier, he protected his battleships by leaving them far behind the rest of the fleet - where they could afford no protection to the carriers, which without sufficient air cover were nearly defenseless against the American dive bombers at Midway.
6. Partly because the Germans believed that you could not mount an invasion without permanent port facilities they were firmly convinced Normandy invasion must really come at Pas de Calais. The result was that they refused to reinforce Normandy even after the beachhead was established. When they did finally move the armoured reserves to support the Normandy forces, Patton trapped them in the bag behind the Falaise Gap. (It is interesting to note that the idea of portable port facilities was so novel and radical that the allies almost refused to accept it. It is no wonder that the Germans didn't take it into their calculations.)

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9. Because Americans found it incomprehensible that a crude technology could effectively defend itself against a sophisticated weapons systems, many aircraft were lost to WWII model antiaircraft and small arms fire in Vietnam.

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Chart A

The Pattern of Objective and Speculative
Material During Observations of Unusual Data

(Speculative Chart)

10 seconds

Objective Data

~~Imaginative~~ Imaginative Speculation

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Chart B - Reporting Index

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50 40 30 20 10 5 1 0

Number of people reported to

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